

GOVCHEAT

govcheat.com

The Ultimate Government Contract Cheat Sheet

How to Find, Win, and Flip Federal Contracts
Even If You've Never Bid Before

\$150B+

Awarded to Small
Business Yearly

500K+

Businesses Registered
on SAM.gov

85%

Never Win
a Single Contract

This cheat sheet is your unfair advantage.
Most people overcomplicate government contracting. This simplifies everything.

govcheat.com - The Cheat Code for Government Contracts

Step 1: Get Registered (Takes 30 Minutes)

1

Get a DUNS/UEI Number

Go to sam.gov and register your business. You'll get a Unique Entity ID (UEI). This is your government ID number. Without it, you can't bid on anything. It's free.

2

Register on SAM.gov

Create your SAM.gov profile. Fill in your business info, NAICS codes (industry codes), and certifications. This takes 20 minutes but unlocks billions in contracts.

3

Get Your NAICS Codes

These are 6-digit codes that describe what your business does. Pick ALL that apply. More codes = more contracts you can bid on. Common ones: 561720 (Janitorial), 541512 (IT), 561320 (Staffing).

4

Apply for Set-Aside Certifications

If you qualify as minority-owned, woman-owned, veteran-owned, or HUBZone, GET CERTIFIED. Set-aside contracts have 3-8 bidders instead of 15+. This is your biggest competitive advantage.

5

Set Up GovCheat Alerts

PRO TIP: 85% of small businesses on SAM.gov never win a contract because they bid on everything. Focus on 3-5 NAICS codes max. Go deep, not wide.

Contract Types Decoded

- > You agree on a price upfront
- > Government pays that amount, period
- > BEST FOR: Simple, well-defined work
- > YOUR ADVANTAGE: Pad your margins
- > If you finish under budget, keep it
- > Easiest type for beginners

- > Bill hourly rates + materials cost
- > Government pays actual hours worked
- > BEST FOR: Uncertain scope projects
- > YOUR ADVANTAGE: Lower risk
- > Mark up labor rates 30-50%
- > Good for staffing contracts

- > Government sets min/max quantities
- > Orders come as task orders over time
- > BEST FOR: Recurring services
- > YOUR ADVANTAGE: Multi-year revenue
- > Win once, get paid for years
- > Build relationship with agency

- > Pre-approved vendor list
- > Agency buys from you repeatedly
- > BEST FOR: Supplies and simple services
- > YOUR ADVANTAGE: Recurring orders
- > Low effort after initial setup
- > Great for product-based businesses

Set-Aside Types (Your Unfair Advantage)

SBA	Total Small Business
8(a)	8(a) Business Development
SDVOSB	Service-Disabled Veteran
WOSB	Woman-Owned Small Business
HUBZone	Historically Underutilized Zone

Any small business can bid

Minority-owned, 3-5 bidders typical

Veteran-owned, very low competition

Woman-owned, growing category

Business in qualified area

The Flip Strategy

Win the Contract. Subcontract the Work. Keep the Margin.

You don't need employees, equipment, or experience to win government contracts. You need a subcontractor who has them. Here's the playbook:

1

Find the Contract

Use GovCheat to find set-aside contracts under \$500K in your NAICS codes. Filter for Low competition. These are your targets.

2

Find 2-3 Subcontractors

Search Google, Indeed, or Thumbtack for companies that already do this work in the contract's area. Get quotes from at least 2-3.

3

Build Your Price

Take the sub's quote. Add your management fee (15-20%). Add margin (10-15%). That's your bid price. Example: Sub quotes \$120K. You bid \$165K. Margin: \$45K.

4

Write the Proposal

REAL PROFIT EXAMPLE

- > Janitorial Contract: \$180K/yr. Sub cost: \$120K. Your profit: \$60K/yr x 5 years = \$300K
- > IT Help Desk: \$350K/yr. Sub 4 techs at \$55K each (\$220K). Your profit: \$130K/yr
- > Staffing: 10 workers at \$18/hr, bill at \$35/hr. Spread: \$17/hr x 2080 hrs = \$353K/yr
- > Translation: Bill \$0.22/word, pay translator \$0.10/word. Pure markup, zero overhead

Winning Proposal Template

1. COVER LETTER

1 page max. State who you are, what you're bidding on, and why you're qualified. Reference the solicitation number. Keep it professional and short.

2. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Half page. Summarize your approach in 3-4 sentences. State your key differentiator. Mention relevant past performance. This is what the evaluator reads first.

3. TECHNICAL APPROACH

1-3 pages. Explain HOW you'll do the work. Break it into phases: Mobilization, Performance, Quality Control. Be specific about timelines and deliverables.

4. MANAGEMENT PLAN

1 page. Show your org chart. Name your project manager. Describe your communication plan (weekly reports, monthly reviews). Show you have a system.

5. STAFFING PLAN

1 page. List key personnel and their qualifications. Explain your recruiting and retention strategy. Include backup/replacement plan.

6. PAST PERFORMANCE

1-2 pages. List 2-3 similar contracts or clients. Include client name, contract value, period, scope, and a reference contact. If you're new, use commercial clients.

7. PRICE PROPOSAL

Separate volume. Break down costs by labor category, materials, ODCs, overhead, G&A, and profit. Make it easy to evaluate. Competitive but not lowest.

Skip the template?

GovCheat's AI Bid Composer writes your proposal in 60 seconds. govcheat.com

Quick Reference & Resources

Essential Websites

SAM.gov	Register your business and find contracts	sam.gov
GovCheat	AI-powered contract search and proposals	govcheat.com
USASpending.gov	See who won past contracts and prices	usaspending.gov
SBA.gov	Small business certifications and resources	sba.gov
FPDS.gov	Federal procurement data system	fpds.gov
GSA.gov	GSA Schedule contracts	gsa.gov

Top NAICS Codes for Beginners

561720	Janitorial Services	Low barrier, high volume, easy to sub
561730	Landscaping Services	Seasonal, easy to sub crews
561320	Temporary Staffing	Pure arbitrage - recruit and bill
541512	IT Support Services	Help desk, desktop support
541810	Advertising/Marketing	Social media, content, fully remote
611430	Professional Training	Build once, deliver repeatedly
561612	Security Guard Services	Sub to staffing agencies
561210	Facilities Support	Maintenance and operations

Key Terms Decoded

SOW	Statement of Work - what the government wants done
COR	Contracting Officer Representative - your main contact
CO	Contracting Officer - the person who signs the contract
IDIQ	Indefinite Delivery/Indefinite Quantity - ongoing task orders
FFP	Firm Fixed Price - agreed price, you keep savings
LPTA	Lowest Price Technically Acceptable - cheapest bid wins
Best Value	Price + quality evaluated together - not always cheapest
Past Performance	Your track record on similar work
CAGE Code	Commercial and Government Entity code - auto-assigned

Stop Reading. Start Winning.

You now know more than 85% of businesses on SAM.gov.
The difference between knowing and earning is action.

Your Next Move

1. Go to govcheat.com and create your free account
2. Search contracts in your NAICS codes
3. Use the AI Bid Composer to write your first proposal
4. Submit your bid before the deadline

govcheat.com

The Cheat Code for Government Contracts